NovaTech Solutions

Employee Handbook

Knowledge Base Document • Version 1.0 • Effective January 2026

Purpose

This handbook provides employees with general information about working at NovaTech Solutions, including workplace expectations, working hours, communication, performance, professional development, and employee responsibilities. It is part of the company's internal knowledge base and is intended to support day-to-day employee questions.

Important: This is a fictional company document created for the Enterprise Knowledge Assistant portfolio project.

Document Owner: People Operations

Review Cycle: Annual

Classification: Internal

1. Company Overview

NovaTech Solutions is a fictional software company that develops cloud-based business applications and data platforms. The company operates with distributed teams across the United States and uses a hybrid work model.

Company Values

- Customer focus — build reliable products that solve meaningful customer problems.
- Ownership — take responsibility for decisions, commitments, and outcomes.
- Collaboration — share information and work constructively across teams.
- Integrity — communicate honestly and protect company and customer information.
- Continuous learning — improve technical, professional, and leadership skills.

2. Employment Basics

Working Hours

Standard business hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM local time. Teams may establish different schedules when business requirements require coverage outside standard hours. Employees should coordinate schedule changes with their manager.

Core Collaboration Hours

For employees working remotely or on flexible schedules, core collaboration hours are 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM Eastern Time. Employees should normally be available for team meetings and urgent collaboration during this period.

Attendance and Punctuality

Employees are expected to attend scheduled meetings, communicate schedule changes promptly, and complete assigned work within agreed deadlines. Repeated attendance or availability issues should be discussed with the employee's manager.

3. Workplace Communication

NovaTech uses company email, Slack, project-management tools, and video conferencing for internal communication. Employees should use the communication channel designated by their team for each type of work.

Communication Guidelines

- Keep work-related communication professional and respectful.
- Use clear subject lines and concise messages for important requests.
- Do not share confidential company information in public or unauthorized channels.
- Document important decisions in the appropriate project or team workspace.
- Employees should acknowledge urgent work requests during their agreed working hours.

4. Workplace Conduct

NovaTech expects employees to maintain a professional, inclusive, and respectful workplace. Employees should treat coworkers, customers, vendors, and business partners with courtesy.

Expected Behavior

- Communicate respectfully, including when disagreeing with another person's ideas.
- Avoid behavior that could reasonably be considered threatening, discriminatory, or harassing.
- Protect company property, systems, credentials, and confidential information.
- Disclose potential conflicts of interest to the appropriate manager or People Operations representative.

Concerns about workplace conduct may be reported to a manager, People Operations, or through the company's designated reporting process. Retaliation against an employee who raises a concern in good faith is prohibited.

5. Performance and Feedback

Employees participate in regular performance conversations with their manager. Managers and employees should discuss goals, progress, development needs, and obstacles throughout the year.

Performance Review Cycle

Formal performance reviews are conducted twice per year. Employees normally complete a self-review before the manager review. Review discussions cover accomplishments, goals, collaboration, strengths, and areas for improvement.

Goal Setting

Employees should establish measurable goals with their manager. Goals may include product delivery, technical contributions, customer outcomes, operational improvements, or professional development.

6. Learning and Career Development

NovaTech encourages employees to develop technical and professional skills. Employees may discuss training, certifications, conferences, mentoring, and stretch assignments with their manager.

Professional Development Requests

Employees should submit training or conference requests to their manager before registering. Requests should include the learning objective, expected cost, and relevance to the employee's role.

The company may provide access to internal learning resources and approved external training. Approval depends on role relevance, budget availability, and team priorities.

7. Company Property and Equipment

Company-issued laptops, mobile devices, security keys, software licenses, and other equipment are provided for authorized business use. Employees are responsible for protecting company equipment from loss, theft, and unauthorized access.

Equipment Responsibilities

- Keep company devices physically secure.
- Use approved security controls such as passwords and multi-factor authentication.
- Do not install unauthorized software on company-managed devices.
- Report lost or stolen company equipment to IT Support as soon as possible.
- Return company property when employment ends or when requested by the company.

8. Confidentiality and Information Handling

Employees may have access to confidential business information, customer information, source code, financial information, and internal plans. Such information must only be accessed and shared when authorized for legitimate business purposes.

Information Handling Principles

- Access only information necessary for your job responsibilities.
- Do not copy confidential information to personal accounts or unauthorized storage services.
- Verify recipients before sending sensitive information.
- Follow the separate IT Security Policy for password, VPN, phishing, and security-incident requirements.

9. Reporting Workplace or Security Concerns

Employees should report suspected security incidents, unauthorized access, lost devices, phishing attempts, or other urgent technology concerns to IT Support immediately. Workplace concerns may be reported to a manager or People Operations.

When reporting an issue, provide the relevant facts, approximate time of the incident, affected system or equipment, and any actions already taken. Employees should not attempt to investigate a suspected security incident beyond their normal responsibilities unless instructed by the security team.

10. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What are NovaTech's standard working hours?

A: Standard business hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM local time.

Q: What are the core collaboration hours for remote employees?

A: Core collaboration hours are 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM Eastern Time.

Q: How often are formal performance reviews conducted?

A: Formal performance reviews are conducted twice per year.

Q: Who should I contact about professional development?

A: Start by discussing the training or development request with your manager.

Q: What should I do if my company laptop is lost?

A: Contact IT Support as soon as possible and provide the relevant details about the lost device.